

NAME

`remove_stale_templates.py` – quarantine stale manual saved templates and prune their schedlist lines

SYNOPSIS

`remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir DIR --quarantine-dir DIR [--years N] [--exclude-owner OWNER ...] [--exclude-owner-regex PATTERN ...] [--execute | --restore RUN_DIR]`

DESCRIPTION

`remove_stale_templates.py` finds *stale saved templates* in a Symphony ILS report-scheduler data directory (*rptsched*) and moves their files into quarantine, removing the corresponding line from *schedlist*.

A saved template (one row of *schedlist*, plus its *<id>.set* / *<id>.selans* file group) is a stale-template candidate when **all** of the following hold:

- **frequency_flag** is **n** – the template is manual (run by hand only), not on a recurring Symphony schedule.
- **owner** is not excluded by any `--exclude-owner` or `--exclude-owner-regex` entry passed on the command line.
- It satisfies the **inactivity rule**: **last_run** is not the "never run" sentinel (**0000000000**) and is at least `--years` years before today; or, if the template has never been run, **created** is at least `--years` years before today.

Unlike orphans, every stale-template candidate has a live *schedlist* line. This tool removes that line – via write-temp-file plus atomic rename, never an in-place edit – so nothing is left dangling. Restoring a run re-inserts the exact removed lines back into the *current* schedlist.

OPTIONS

`--data-dir DIR`

Path to the *rptsched* data directory to scan and modify. Required in every mode, including `--restore`.

`--quarantine-dir DIR`

Path to the quarantine directory that holds run subfolders. Created if it does not already exist. Required in every mode.

`--years N`

Inactivity threshold in years, applied to both **last_run** and, when the template has never run, **created**. Default: 3.

`--exclude-owner OWNER`

Exclude templates whose **owner** is an exact, case-insensitive match for *OWNER*. Repeatable – pass once per owner to exclude a specific set. No substring matching: `--exclude-owner ACQ1` excludes only an owner literally named **ACQ1**, not **ACQ10**. Not set by default – this script excludes no owners unless told to.

`--exclude-owner-regex PATTERN`

Exclude templates whose **owner** matches regex *PATTERN* via case-insensitive, unanchored **re.search**. Repeatable. Breadth is the caller's responsibility through regex syntax – e.g. **ACQ** matches **ACQ1**, **ACQHQ**, and **jsmith-acq** anywhere in the owner string; **^ACQ** matches only owners starting with it. Not set by default.

`--execute`

Perform the move and the *schedlist* rewrite. Without this flag the script runs in dry-run mode and writes nothing.

`--restore RUN_DIR`

Reverse a previous `--execute` run: restore quarantined files, then re-insert their removed *schedlist* lines. Mutually exclusive with `--execute`.

MODES

Dry run (default)

Prints the count of stale-template candidates, the total count of manual templates in *schedlist* (regardless of staleness or owner exclusion), and total files, then one line per candidate: id, description, owner, frequency_flag, created, last_run, and its file list. Nothing on disk is touched.

Execute

With **--execute**, the script:

1. Finds candidates as described above. If none are found, prints a message and exits 0 without creating a run subfolder.
2. Creates **--quarantine-dir**/templates_*TIMESTAMP* and moves each candidate's file group into it, writing *manifest.csv* (same mechanics and partial-failure behavior as **remove_orphans.py**(1)).
3. Writes the exact removed *schedlist* lines, verbatim and in id order, to *removed_schedlist_lines.txt* in the run subfolder.
4. Rewrites *schedlist* to drop those lines, via a temp file plus atomic rename.

Steps 3 and 4 only run after every file in step 2 has been moved successfully; a move failure aborts before *schedlist* is touched, so a failed run never produces a dangling *schedlist* line.

Restore

With **--restore** *RUN_DIR*, the script:

1. Restores quarantined files exactly as **remove_orphans.py**(1)'s **--restore** does: idempotent, resumable, skips rows whose *dest_path* no longer exists, aborts on a *source_path* collision.
2. Reads *RUN_DIR/removed_schedlist_lines.txt* (if present – an empty result is treated as "no lines to reinsert", not an error) and re-inserts each line into the **current** *schedlist*, then re-sorts the file by id.

The re-insert step is idempotent independently of the file-restore step: it skips any line whose id is already present in the current *schedlist*, so it is safe even if the current *schedlist* has legitimate edits made after the original removal run, and safe to re-run.

EXIT STATUS

- 0** Success – including a clean dry run, an execute run that found zero candidates, or a restore that skipped everything because it was already complete.
- 1** A move, *schedlist* rewrite, or restore operation failed. Details are printed to stderr.

FILES

<*data-dir*>/*schedlist*

Read to find candidates; rewritten in place (atomically) by **--execute** to drop matched lines, and again by **--restore** to re-insert them.

<*quarantine-dir*>/templates_<*timestamp*>/*manifest.csv*

File-move record, same format as **remove_orphans.py**(1).

<*quarantine-dir*>/templates_<*timestamp*>/*removed_schedlist_lines.txt*

The exact *schedlist* lines removed by this run, one per line, verbatim. Never deleted – required for **--restore** and doubles as an audit record.

EXAMPLES

Preview stale templates using the default 3-year threshold:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine
```

Use a 5-year threshold instead:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --years 5
```

Execute a run:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --execute
```

Exclude a specific list of owners:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --exclude-owner ACQ1 --exclude-owner ACQ2
```

Exclude any owner containing "ACQ", regardless of case:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --exclude-owner-regex ACQ
```

Undo a specific run (files and schedlist lines both):

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --restore ./quarantine/templates_20260826_140501
```

SEE ALSO

remove_orphans.py(1), **sync_operator_field.py**(1)

Domain reference: *rptsched-domain-reference.md* in the rptsched-cleanup repository – see "Inactivity rule" and "Owner exclusion" under "Definitions", and the *schedlist* field table.

CAVEATS

Requires Python 3.6.8, standard library only.

The **--years** value must match between the run that removed a template and any later reasoning about it; restore replays the exact removed line rather than re-evaluating staleness, so it is unaffected by a later change to **--years**.

This tool only ever considers manual templates (**frequency_flag** == "n"). Recurring-schedule templates are the separate, not-yet-built "scheduled report removal candidates" category described in the project's CLAUDE.md.